Read Words in Context

READ!

A Dog's Life!

Dogs come in **assorted** shapes and sizes, both big and small. Among the largest dogs is the **massive** Saint Bernard, which can weigh up to 200 pounds! A **mature**, grown-up Saint Bernard stands about two feet high at the shoulder. It's probably not a good idea to have any **fragile**, or easily broken, objects around when a Saint Bernard wags its tail in your home!

Some dogs are **easygoing** pets who are calm and relaxed. Others are **mischievous**. These playful creatures often get into trouble with their frisky behavior. They may chew your slippers, shred a newspaper, or even hide your socks! Some dogs are **adventurous**. Rin Tin Tin, a famous German shepherd, was a police dog. He liked excitement. He starred in a television show, where he performed many **heroic** tasks, such as bravely rescuing people from danger.

Some dogs are very **peculiar** to look at. They might have big, sad eyes, floppy ears, or shaggy coats, so they look quite odd. Some dogs are beautiful. It's best to wash dogs regularly so their coats stay clean and shiny. When dogs are clean, they can have a fresh, **fragrant** smell.

Shrewd, experienced people train dogs to help humans in different ways. For example, some specially trained dogs help handicapped and blind people with their daily tasks. These **confident** dogs are secure and certain of their abilities, and are very dedicated to the people they help.

Many dogs are **beloved** pets whose owners adore them. President Franklin D. Roosevelt, a very **distinguished** person who was President of the United States, took his terrier, Fala, with him almost everywhere.



You can tell that dogs make **outstanding** pets and helpers. They can be wonderful company. That's why there are nearly 58 million pet dogs in America!

Vocabulary Words

adventurous
assorted
beloved
confident
distinguished
easygoing
fragile
fragrant
heroic
massive
mature
mischievous
outstanding
peculiar
shrewd

Word Learning Tip!

An **adjective** is a word that describes a noun or a pronoun. You can use its placement in the sentence as a clue to its meaning. An adjective often comes before the noun it describes or after a linking verb. Adjectives tell *what kind, which one, how many,* or *how much.* An adjective can end in *-ant, -ent, -ar, -ent, -ic, -ile, -ive,* or *-ous*.

Vocabulary Building Strategy

Use Context Clues You can often find the meaning of an adjective you don't know by using nearby words in the sentence as context clues. These words can help you determine what a new adjective means.

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Connect Words and Meanings

adventurous	confident	fragile	massive	outstanding
assorted	distinguished	fragrant	mature	peculiar
beloved	easygoing	heroic	mischievous	shrewd

Directions Find the word that matches each description. Then use the words to fill in the blanks. When you have completed the entire puzzle, you will see another vocabulary word when you read down the squares. Write this word in the blank beside item 10.

	Definition	Word
1.	strange or odd	___ ___ □ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___
2.	very brave or daring	___ ___ ___ □ ___ ___
3.	known for important things; dignified	___ ___ ___ ___ ___ □ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___
4.	sweet smelling	□ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___
5.	delicate, easily broken	___ ___ ___ ___ □ ___ ___
6.	extremely good	___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ □ ___ ___ ___
7.	calm and relaxed	□ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___
8.	likes excitement	___ ___ ___ ___ □ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___ ___
9.	various kinds of	___ ___ ___ ___ ___ □ ___ ___
10.	self-assured, secure	_____

Continued on next page

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Connect More Words and Meanings

adventurous	**confident**	**fragile**	**massive**	**outstanding**
assorted	**distinguished**	**fragrant**	**mature**	**peculiar**
beloved	**easygoing**	**heroic**	**mischievous**	**shrewd**

Directions Read each definition. Write the vocabulary word that matches the definition in the blank. You may use the glossary to help you.

	Definitions	Vocabulary Words
11.	adored	_____
12.	very large	_____
13.	grown-up	_____
14.	gets into trouble	_____
15.	clever; sharp	_____

Directions Use your knowledge of word meanings to complete each sentence below.

16. Someone who helps other people even when there is danger is _____.

17. A puppy who is always getting into mischief can be described as _____.

18. If you like to have fun and adventures, you might be called _____.

19. An older and wiser person is _____.

20. Someone you treasure and who is dear to your heart can be described as _____.

Write a Letter In your personal word journal, write a letter to an organization that helps animals. Ask what kind of volunteer work the organization has available. Tell them about yourself and what qualities you have that would make you a good volunteer. Challenge yourself to use at least three vocabulary words when you write the letter. Also include at least two new adjectives.

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Use Words in Context

adventurous	confident	fragile	massive	outstanding
assorted	distinguished	fragrant	mature	peculiar
beloved	easygoing	heroic	mischievous	shrewd

Directions Read each sentence below. Use the context clues in boldface to choose a vocabulary word. Then use the vocabulary word to write an answer to each question.

1. How could a cute puppy get into **so much trouble** and cause so many problems?

   _____

2. What **different kinds** of animals might you find in an animal shelter? Name at least three different types of animals. _____

3. Where would you go with a dog who likes **excitement** and is **willing to take risks**?

   _____

4. What might a **brave** dog do if its master were in trouble? _____

   _____

5. How could a **huge** dog help people because it is so big? _____

   _____

6. What is the **strangest** dog you've ever seen? _____

   _____

7. Why do people like relaxed and **calm** dogs? _____

   _____

8. What would be an **extremely good** reward to give to a brave dog?

   _____

9. What might a **clever and cunning** pet-store owner do to sell more dog food?

   _____

10. What could a manufacturer do to make dog food more **sweet smelling**?

    _____

Create a "Lost Pet" Ad Look through magazines for a photo of a pet. Use it to create an ad that you could post to help locate a lost pet. Use at least five vocabulary words and three new adjectives.

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Put Words Into Action

adventurous	**confident**	**fragile**	**massive**	**outstanding**
assorted	**distinguished**	**fragrant**	**mature**	**peculiar**
beloved	**easygoing**	**heroic**	**mischievous**	**shrewd**

Directions Think of a famous public figure you admire. It could be someone living today or someone from the past. Write five sentences providing clues to help classmates guess who this person is. Use one vocabulary word in each clue. For example, "He is an **outstanding** pitcher who is in the Baseball Hall of Fame."

Clue #1 _____

_____

Clue #2 _____

_____

Clue #3 _____

_____

Clue #4 _____

_____

Clue #5 _____

_____



Write a Character Sketch In your personal word journal, write a character sketch about your public figure. Before you start writing, think about what characteristics you admire the most. Use your clues to help you write a sketch that describes the person. Try to use at least four vocabulary words and four new adjectives.

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Review and Extend

adventurous	**confident**	**fragile**	**massive**	**outstanding**
assorted	**distinguished**	**fragrant**	**mature**	**peculiar**
beloved	**easygoing**	**heroic**	**mischievous**	**shrewd**

Learn More!

The ending of a word can be a clue that it is an adjective. Here are some common endings for adjectives.

-ant/-ent *(causing, having)*	**-ar** *(like; that which)*	**-ic** *(like)*	**-ile** *(like, able)*	**-ive** *(having, full of)*	**-ous** *(full of)*
confident	peculiar	heroic	fragile	massive	adventurous
fragrant	singular	poetic	juvenile	sensitive	nervous
defiant					

Directions Read each sentence below. Find the vocabulary word that best matches the boldface word or words and write it in the first blank. Then write the ending in the second blank.

Brave and well-trained dogs made it possible to get medicine to faraway places in Alaska.

1. Word: _____
2. Ending: _____

Many dogs are well trained and **certain of their skills**.

3. Word: _____
4. Ending: _____

Very large dogs called *Huskies* are used to pull dog sleds in cold areas.

5. Word: _____
6. Ending: _____

Some dogs are **bold and daring** and seem to enjoy new challenges.

7. Word: _____
8. Ending: _____

Delicate dogs, with small bones and thin coats, would not survive in such cold places.

9. Word: _____
10. Ending: _____

Write a Tall Tale Work with a partner to write a tall tale about a heroic animal who goes on a great adventure. Brainstorm with your partner a few ideas that might make an interesting or amusing story. Choose one of the ideas and write a tall tale. Use at least three vocabulary words and three new adjectives in your story.

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Check Your Mastery

Directions Circle the letter of the correct answer to each question below.

1. Which of the following could mean that a person is **adventurous**?
- **A.** taking a nap
- **B.** watching television
- **C.** planting seeds
- **D.** climbing a rugged mountain

2. If the air were sweet and **fragrant**, what might it smell like?
- **A.** sugar
- **B.** flowers
- **C.** old socks
- **D.** burning rubber

3. Which of the following characteristics would a **heroic** person have?
- **A.** musical talent
- **B.** friendliness
- **C.** courage
- **D.** weakness

4. What might an **outstanding** citizen receive?
- **A.** a medal
- **B.** an education
- **C.** a lesson in good manners
- **D.** a puppy

5. What might a **mischievous** puppy do?
- **A.** smell good
- **B.** chew your slippers
- **C.** sit on your lap
- **D.** eat dinner

Directions Read each item below. For each, fill in the blank with the word that best fits.

6. _____ (*Fragile, Mature, Peculiar*) dogs are usually easier to handle than young puppies.

7. Benny has an _____ (*assorted, easygoing, adventurous*) dog who is always calm and not brave at all!

8. Lucy's _____ (*beloved, confident, shrewd*) dog is adored by the entire family.

9. Alejandro has a _____ (*fragile, massive, peculiar*) dog that weighs almost 175 pounds!

10. Mai Ka met a very _____ (*distinguished, mischievous, fragrant*) trainer who is noted for her incredible dog-training skills.

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